Shervin Zare

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Dear Metrolinx Hiring Team

I am excited to apply to Metrolinx for the HR Analytics Co-op role. As a Data Science student at Wilfrid Laurier University, specializing in Big Data, I bring a strong foundation in Python, SQL, and data visualization, as well as hands-on experience with automation, testing, and collaborative development. I am eager to contribute meaningfully to your team while continuing to grow my skills in a professional environment.

In my current roles as **Director of Education at CaseHacks** & **Educational Content Creator at Laurier Analytics Society**, I have developed a strong blend of technical, leadership, and collaboration skills that align closely with Metrolinx's analytics-driven culture. I designed and delivered educational workshops in analytics, machine learning, and programming, translating complextechnical concepts into clear, accessible learning experiences for students fromdiverse backgrounds. Working closely with multiple departments, I coordinated initiatives across teams, managed competing priorities, and ensured alignment among stakeholders. This role strengthened my ability to communicate effectively with both technical and non-technical audiences, work cross-functionally, and proactively solve problems, skills that are essential for supporting data-driven decision-making and collaborative analytics projects at Metrolinx.

As a **Data Analytics Intern at Union Dome**, I gained hands-on experience working with real-world data, stakeholders, and business problems. I worked extensively with Python and SQL to clean, prepare, and analyze large datasets, ensuring data quality and reliability for downstream analytics. I collaborated with product and business teams to support reporting, dashboarding, and analytics initiatives, using tools like Git, cloud platforms, and visualization platforms to create reproducible workflows. I also contributed to machine learning and automation efforts that required feature engineering, structured data pipelines, and clear documentation. Throughout this experience, I developed the ability to translate ambiguous business questions into structured analytical approaches and communicate insights in a clear, actionable way.

I am particularly drawn to Metrolinx because of its commitment to using data and analytics to improve user experiences and solve meaningful business problems. I am excited by the opportunity to contribute to a collaborative, innovative, and learning-focused environment where I can apply my technical foundation while continuing to develop professionally. I am confident that my combination of technical skills, leadership experience, and strong communication abilities would allowme to contribute effectively to your analytics team while embracing Metrolinx's culture of growth, inclusion, and continuous learning.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experiences align with the needs of your team.

Sincerely,
Shervin Zare

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Education

Wilfrid Laurier University Sep 2023 – Apr 2027
Bachelor of Science in Data Science *Waterloo, ON*

- Coursework: Data Analytics, Data Visualization, Database, Software Engineering, Business I

Experience

Educational Programs Developer Sep 2025 – Present
Laurier Analytics Society *Waterloo, ON*

- Developed educational content and video modules that simplified complex data and technology concepts, helping over 100 students deepen their understanding and stay engaged throughout the learning process.
- Delivered hands-on workshops in analytics, machine learning, and programming, giving students practical experience with real-world tools and improving technical confidence; reached 80% of attendees reporting improved skills in post-workshop surveys.
- Organized major networking events with speakers from companies like Google and Sun Life, driving 40% growth in event attendance and increasing student participation in industry-facing initiatives.

Data Analyst May 2025 – Aug 2025
Union Dome Inc. *Toronto, ON*

- Analyzed union member and platform usage data using SQL, Python, and pandas, uncovering engagement trends that guided product improvements and drove an 18% increase in platform usage.
- Collaborated on automated dashboards, leveraging Git-based version control, Python scripts, and scheduled data jobs, ensuring reliable and reproducible reporting for product and client teams and reducing ad-hoc reporting requests by 28%.
- Developed a machine learning pipeline using AWS (S3) to ingest, clean, and preprocess raw union platform data, engineered features, and trained logistic regression models to predict membership renewal, achieving 86% prediction accuracy and providing actionable insights that guided product improvements, informed feature prioritization, and supported CRE occupancy planning initiatives.
- Translated ambiguous business questions into analytical workflows, defining metrics, validating data quality, and presenting insights through Python visualizations (Matplotlib/Seaborn) and Tableau dashboards to non-technical stakeholders, reducing follow-up clarification requests by 21% and accelerating decision-making.

Projects

Customer Conversion Predictor | *pandas, scikit-learn, XGBoost, Data Preprocessing, Feature Engineering, seaborn*

- Developed a deployable XGBoost model for predicting term deposit subscriptions, achieving 82.8% accuracy and 83.7% recall, and packaged the final trained model within an end-to-end pipeline to facilitate immediate, data-driven targeting of high-probability customers and optimize marketing ROI.
- Implemented advanced feature engineering, pre-processing, and stratified sampling on imbalanced data, generating actionable insights through precision-recall analysis, ROC curves, and confusion matrices to improve conversion efficiency by 23%.

RAG-Powered Chatbot | *RAG, LangChain, Streamlit, HuggingFace Embeddings, Vector Database, ChatGPT*

- Engineered a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) chatbot using Streamlit and LangChain, integrating HuggingFace embeddings and an in-memory vector store to enable fast, context-aware document search and question answering.
- Enhanced user interaction with dynamic input modes (URL and file upload), automated text processing, and context visualization, enabling financial and business users to quickly extract insights from unstructured documents, streamline reporting, and support data-driven decision-making.

Stock News Sentiment | *pandas, NLP, FinBERT, Yahoo Finance API, Requests*

- Built a Python tool using Yahoo Finance API and FinBERT to fetch, analyze, and classify real-time stock news sentiment, aggregate results into structured dataframes, and allow users to input any stock ticker and lookback period for actionable market insights.

Technical Skills

Libraries: pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, LangChain, XGBoost, PyTorch, streamlit, requests, seaborn, BeautifulSoup, transformers, Matplotlib
DevOps/MLOps: Git, Docker, MLflow
Cloud Platforms: AWS (S3, SageMaker, Lambda), Azure, Snowflake
Frameworks: React, Node.js, Flask, FastAPI, Transformers
Developer Tools: Git, VS Code, Tableau, Jupyter Notebook, Eclipse, Power BI